

LEAVES OF GRASS

Songs of Myself and the Open Road

WALT WHITMAN

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I. Song of the Open Road

Afoot and light-hearted I take to the open road, healthy, free, the world before me,
the long brown path before me leading wherever I choose.

Henceforth I ask not good-fortune, I myself am good-fortune. Strong and content I
travel the open road, done with indoor complaints, done with libraries, quarrels, and
querulous criticisms.

You road I enter upon and look around, I believe you are not all that is here, I
believe that much unseen is also here.

II. A Leaf for the Field

I celebrate myself, and sing myself, and what I assume you shall assume, for every atom belonging to me as good belongs to you.

I loafe and invite my soul, I lean and loafe at my ease observing a spear of summer grass, and find in it the whole turning of the seasons.

The smallest sprout shows there is really no death, and if ever there was it led forward life, and does not wait at the end to arrest it.